

Better quality

Canon's PgR technology promises to deliver superior plain paper printing

**Fedora 12**

It released recently with security improvements and virtualization enhancements

Samsung i8910 Omnia HD

Symbian meets capacitive touch...finally

At first you'll be surprised by the sheer footprint of this phone – it's slim (12.9mm), but as long as Nokia's E90. Then you notice the large (obviously) touch screen and the narrow size bezel and you realise you behold something well designed. The shiny black body that is only relieved by a chrome bezel running around the screen is constructed well, but it lacks the sheer solidness of metal. The large call buttons are placed on either side of the menu button and lie slap-bang amid the chrome trim. The battery cover is a firm fit. The 3.5mm jack is on top of the phone under a rather large flap. The volume switch is located on the left, while there is a tiny screen lock button on the side; the camera button although raised, is not the easiest to use thanks to iffy feedback.

We loved the interface. Symbian on a capacitive touch screen is very rare, and the shortcomings of the touch interface on the Nokia N97 have been fully addressed here. Although Symbian icons are distinct, the widget-heavy, TouchWiz interface will leave some Symbian users nonplussed at first. The screen is responsive and the touch interface is quite fluid, except for the scrolling that still relies on a scroll bar unlike Apples uber-slick, gesture-based scroll. The number

keypad works well for anyone used to Symbian – not as good as a hardware keypad, but not bad. The onscreen QWERTY keypad is a nice option, but isn't as usable as the number keypad, although the large screen means well spaced-out keys.

Grunt is provided by an ARM Cortex A8 600 MHz processor and there is a dedicated graphics chip in the form of the PowerVR SGX – thanks to this virtually everything is snappy, but the screen transition effects are

pretty sapping and disabling this speeds things up further. The battery, despite its huge rating, drains pretty soon, thanks to the large screen and even with moderate usage needs charging daily.

The camera takes good photos, but a better flash would be welcome. Video quality is also good – a bigger resolution (720p) does help when viewing on a bigger screen. Low-light shooting is not as good. Signal quality is one region where we weren't satisfied, and although it shares an interface with Nokia,

the Omnia HD cannot hold a candle to many Nokia phones including the N97, when it comes to signal strength, signal integrity and call clarity. In-call volume is good, but only in a silent environment – it should have been louder. The loudspeaker quality is not as good as we expected from a phone in this price bracket. It should have been louder, since many will use this to watch videos. That's not to say its bad, but there's headroom for improvement. Hands-free clarity is good, and the earphones while decent for music are not superlative and the volume should have been around 20 per cent more. Browsing is a nice experience, with the ability to resize web pages at a finger swipe.

At a price of Rs. 33,990, the Omnia HD is a very good effort and has a really sweet interface, a huge screen, good camera and decent hardware, but a few significant glitches prevent it from being heartily recommended.

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Price: Rs. 33,990

Specifications

Weight: 148 gm; **Screen:** 3.7-inch, capacitive touch, 360 x 640 pixels; **Camera:** 8 MP, 720p video recording; **Battery:** 1500 mAh; **Details:** Inbuilt Wi-Fi, GPS, 8/16 GB internal storage, microSD expansion

RATINGS

Features	8
Performance	8
Build Quality	8
Value	6
Overall	7.5